

Rutgers Taiwanese American Student Association

Team 2

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Company Access

MONTH YEAR

Rutgers University Taiwanese American Student Association

*Promote and build awareness of Taiwanese culture, food, and
language in the Rutgers community while educating and
empowering the next generation of our nation's leaders.*

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Background Information and Secondary Data Research

Strategy

Promote Taiwanese culture through food, language, cultural events, and community-building activities.

Competition

Competes with other cultural student groups for student attention and participation.

Roles

Internal board manages communication, task assignment, and coordination; external board communicates with Rutgers and other organizations.

Demographics

Members are mostly Rutgers students ages 17–23 with interest in Taiwanese culture.

Data Collection Methods and Timeline

MONTH YEAR

5



Week

- Initial Contact with TASA
- Discussed project goals
- Scheduled interviews and developed research plan

6-8

Week

- Conducted interviews with executive board members
- Gathered insight on culture, productivity, and leadership
- Identified early challenges and themes

7-9

Week

- Observed TASA meetings/events
- Analyzed interactions between members and group dynamics
- Compared observations with responses from interviews

10-11

Week

- Analyzed all collected data
- Identified core output problem
- Connected findings to course concepts

Output Problem: **Imbalance between a relaxed culture and consistent productivity and leadership continuity**

- Casual Culture -> reduced urgency and efficiency
- Leadership turnover -> loss of knowledge
- Inconsistent accountability among members

“Every year you are restarting”

- TASA Member



Expectancy Theory

What is Expectancy Theory?

A motivational theory explaining how people decide how much effort to put into a task

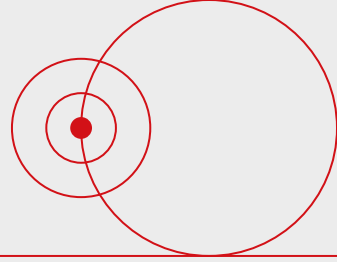
The Core Idea

Motivation is determined by the relationship between effort exerted and perceived level of performance, the anticipation that rewards will be related to performance, and the assumption that rewards will be available

The Three Links

Motivation depends on "Expectancy (E), Instrumentality (I), and Valence (V)". If any of these links are missing or weak, a person will not feel motivated to do the work

Evidence - Colin



Missing Motivation

Shadower Colin Hou stated he is only motivated "if it's something that I actually need to" do

Result of Unclear Rewards

If a task is "not that important," he is "not too motivated."

Impact on Productivity

This lack of drive leads to "a lot of wasted time sometimes" where members are "just fooling around" instead of working

Evidence

- TASA relies entirely on "self-accountability" in a "low stress environment"
- Members "can work at their own pace," some "just don't do their work."
- The middle link of Expectancy Theory (Instrumentality) is broken. Members do not see a clear reward for finishing tasks early.
 - Without a system to track progress or reward hard work, motivation is destroyed, creating a highly unproductive meeting environment.



Deep-Level Diversity

What is Deep-Level Diversity?

Deep-level diversity involves unobservable attributes, including personalities, values, and attitudes". This is different from visible traits like age or race

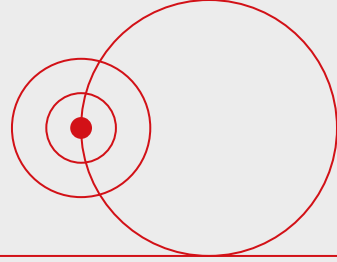
Why It Matters

A successful club needs a good mix of these invisible skills (like event planning, budgeting, or communicating with the school) to run smoothly

The Benefits

Differences in these deep-level attributes "broaden their range of knowledge and perspectives and generate novel ideas and problem solutions

Evidence



Losing Vital Skills

Amanda Chen pointed out that a major challenge with turnover is that "there are people who might leave with very specific skills that are hard to replace."

Learning Curve

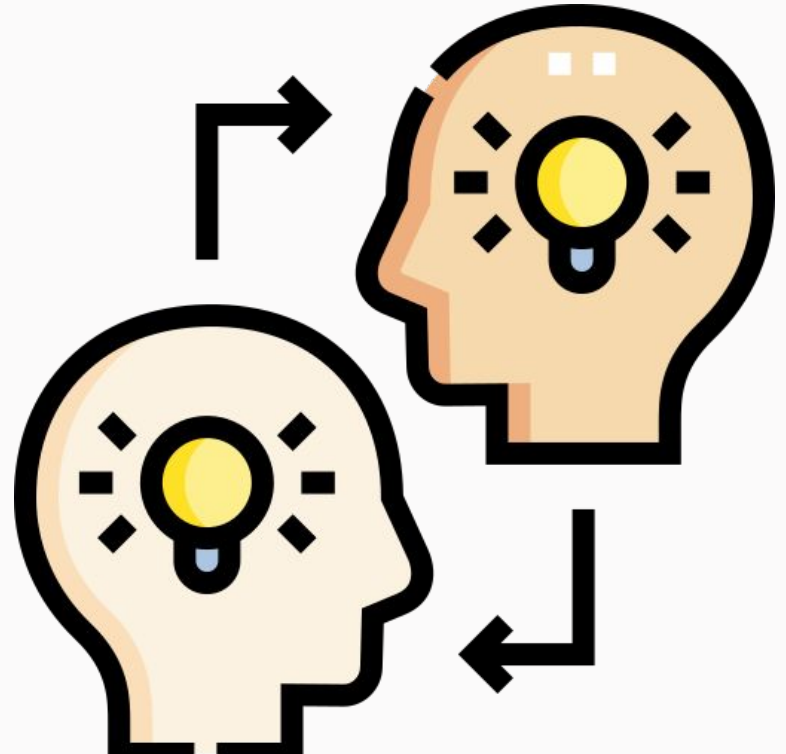
This loss of specific skills creates a tough "learning curve in the beginning" for new leaders.

Failing to Pass Down Knowledge

Yilin Zhao explained that transferring knowledge often fails because of "miscommunication" and because "people are not prioritizing the ability to pass on stuff."

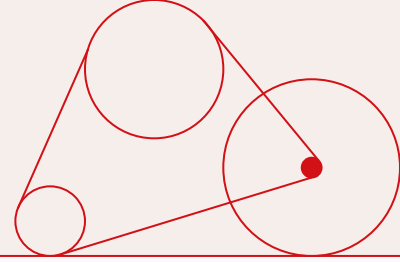
Integration with Output Problem

- "As group members learn more about each other, they are thought to develop cognitive structures... that contain information about member roles, member characteristics, and developmental progress within the team"
- When experienced leaders graduate, they take their specific deep-level knowledge and these mental structures with them.
- Because TASA does not prioritize passing down these skills, they constantly loses its Deep-Level Diversity. The new board is forced to start from scratch, which causes a massive "time setback" because "every year you are restarting"



Recommendation #1

Performance-Tracking System



Objective: Fix “wasted time” and “freeform” meeting structures

Problem:

- Current meetings lack structure
- Redundant info
- Decreased productivity

Key Features

1

List of Tasks:

Expected to be completed during each meeting

2

Point System: Tasks completed ahead of schedule earn points toward monthly outings

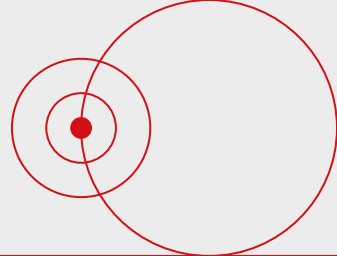
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Autonomy: Allow board members to define their own task lists

Outcome

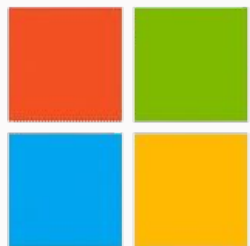
Increased focus, higher board morale, and reduced wasted time

Potential Downside Unhealthy Competition



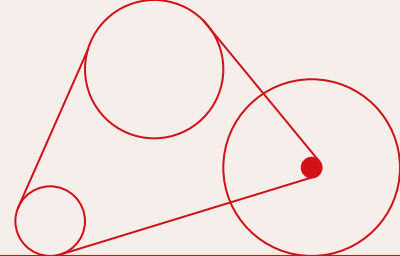
Downside: the point system could cause members to compete against each other instead of working as a team.

- Members become focused on individual results
- Members may work to to make others look bad
- Microsoft “Stack Ranking” system



Microsoft

Recommendation #2: Shadowing & Transitional Program



Objective: Prevent the loss of specialized skills

Problem: Knowledge gaps from board turnover

1

Shadowing period:

Applicants complete tasks under the supervision of current leads

2

Transitional Documents:

current board members are expected to create a transitional document (How-To-Guide) for their position

3

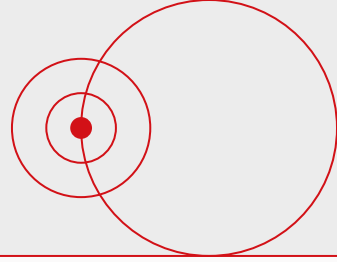
Diverse Recruitment:

Recruit shadowers from different majors and backgrounds to increase Deep-Level Diversity

Outcome

Increased passage of skills across generations.

Potential Downside Burnout



Downside: Shadowing program may eliminate the creativity in the organization

- Shadowers have to spend weeks of their own time to shadow while also being a student themselves
- Making board members keep a detailed record of what they did in their position may feel like too much work to members
- 3M made employees document and justify their ideas
- This process can stop creative thinking



Communication strategies and influencing tactics

MONTH YEAR

Logical Appeal

- ➔ Use Evidence-Based approach to justify Performance-Tracking System
- ➔ Present success metrics from industry leaders (i.e. Google's OKRs)

Involvement Strategy

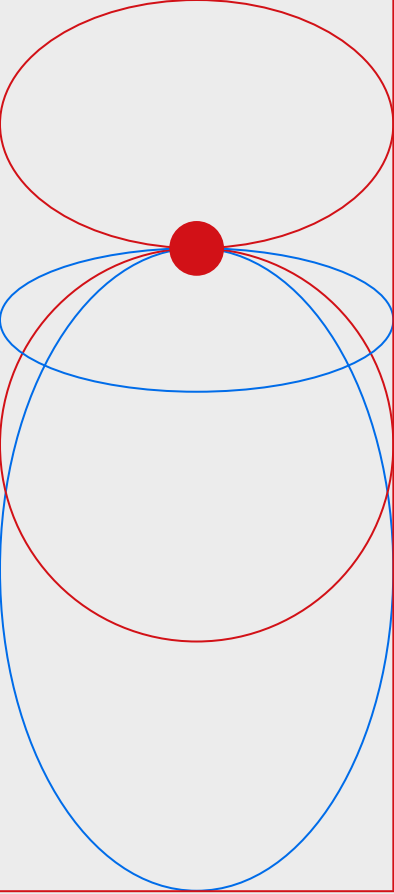
- ➔ Increase commitment by involving board members in the design of Tasks
- ➔ Allow members to define their own key results, increase autonomy + motivation

Values-Based Strategy

- ➔ Connect Shadowing and Transitional Programs to the long-term vision of TASA

Legitimizing Tactics

- ➔ Use high-status benchmarks to validate methods
- ➔ Communicate where the transition documents came from (After Action Review from U.S. Army)



*Thank
you*